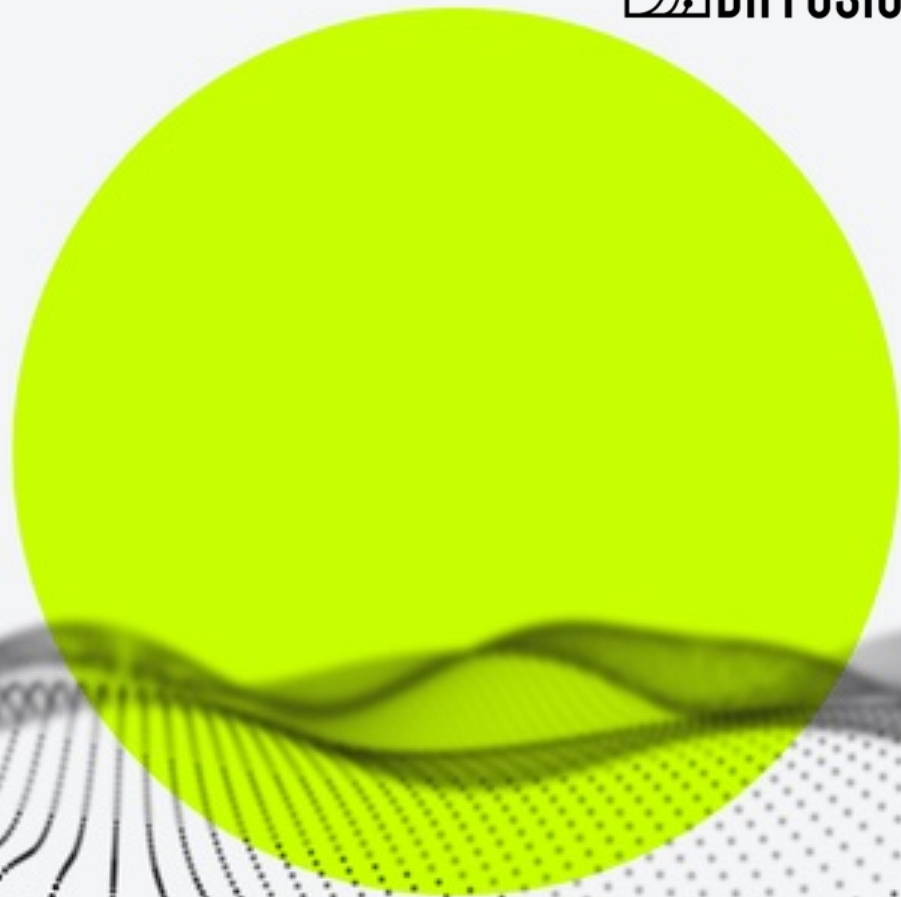


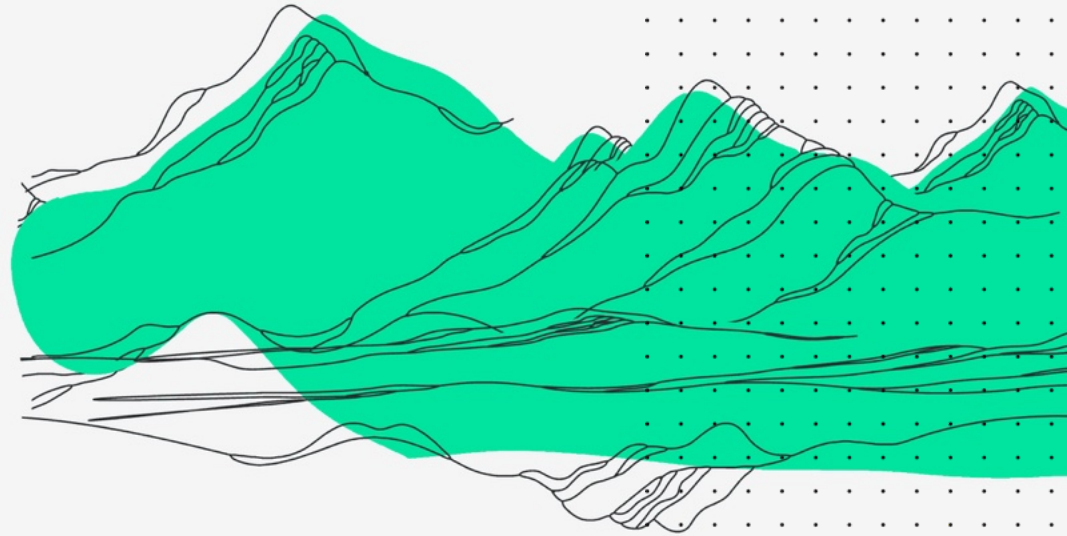
Justin

Founder & CEO | Diffusion AI, Inc

McCarthy



Day 2: Now



Simon Willison's Weblog

How StrongDM's AI team build serious software without even looking at the code

Last week I [hinted at](#) a demo I had seen from a team implementing what Dan Shapiro called the [Dark Factory](#) level of AI adoption, where no human even looks at the code the coding agents are producing. That team was part of StrongDM, and they've just shared the first public description of how they are working in [Software Factories and the Agentic Moment](#):

We built a **Software Factory**: non-interactive development where specs + scenarios drive agents that write code, run harnesses, and converge without human review. [...]

In kōan or mantra form:

- Why am I doing this? (implied: the model should be doing this instead)

STRONGDM AI

Software Factories And The Agentic Moment

February 6th, 2026 · Justin McCarthy



Ethan Mollick

@emollick



A genuinely radical approach to software development with AI, without any human intervention. Even if this approach doesn't work for many cases, I think we need more leapfrogging visions for how to redo processes with AI: factory.strongdm.ai

JANUARY 23, 2026

THE FIVE LEVELS: FROM SPICY AUTOCOMPLETE TO THE DARK FACTORY



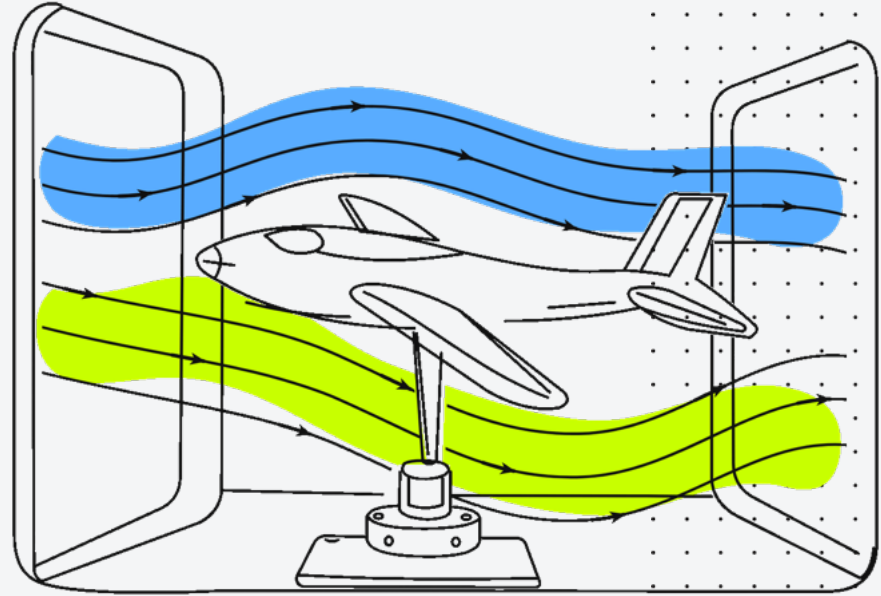
Garry Tan

@garrytan

What a powerful idea

We built a **Software Factory**: non-interactive development where specs + scenarios drive agents

Day 1:



Validation

 DIFFUSION | PRINCIPLES

01 | Desire strongly.

02 | If the agent can do it, you MUST NOT do it.

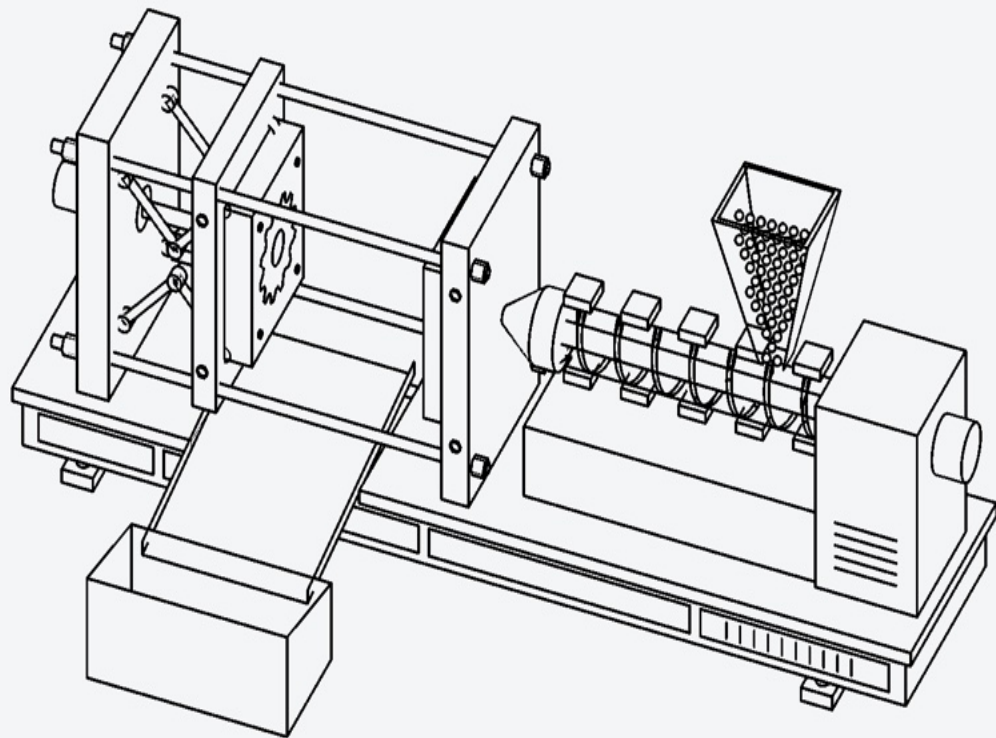
03 | You only have what you can validate.

04 | Multi-model is mandatory.

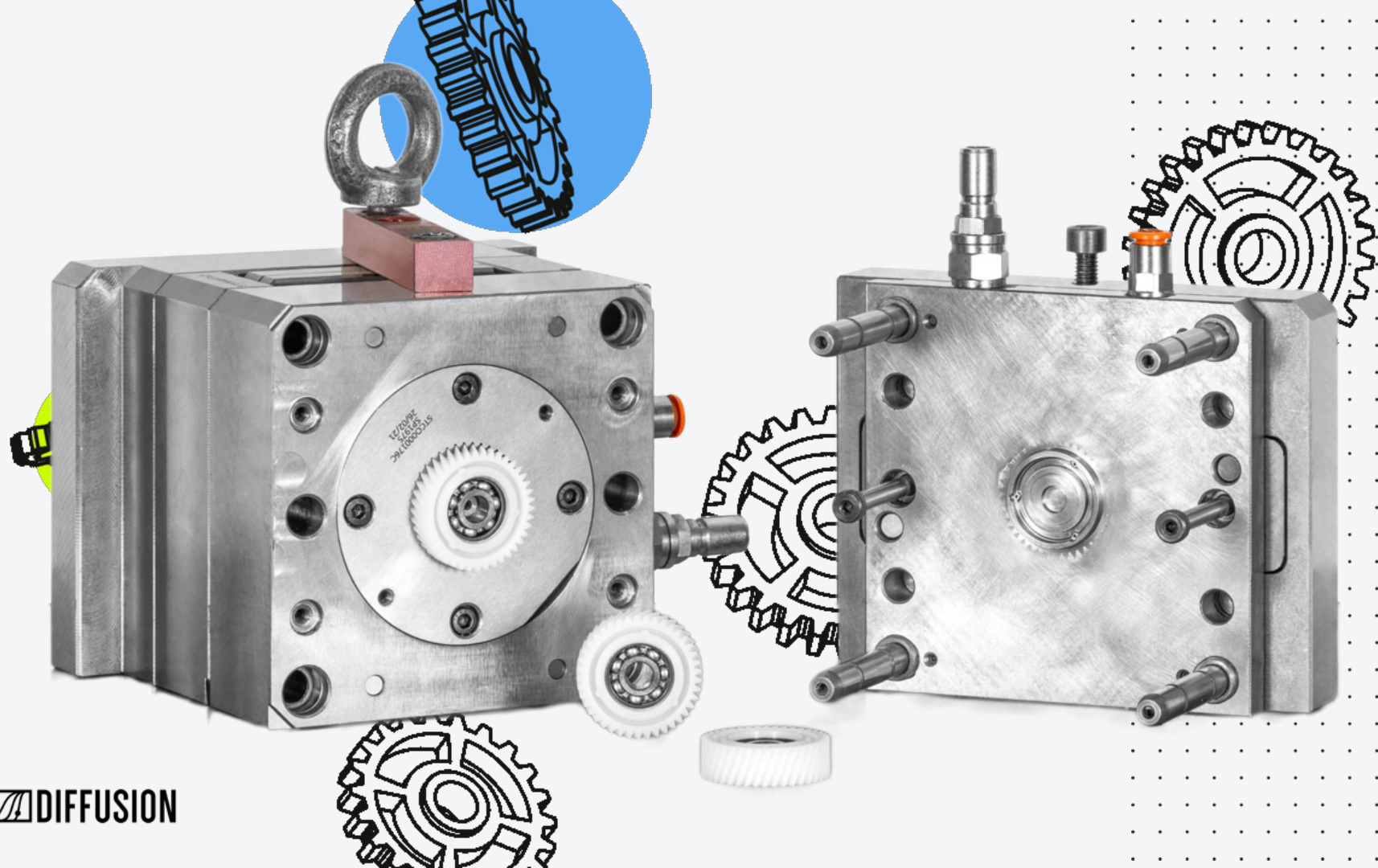
05 | Demand und-

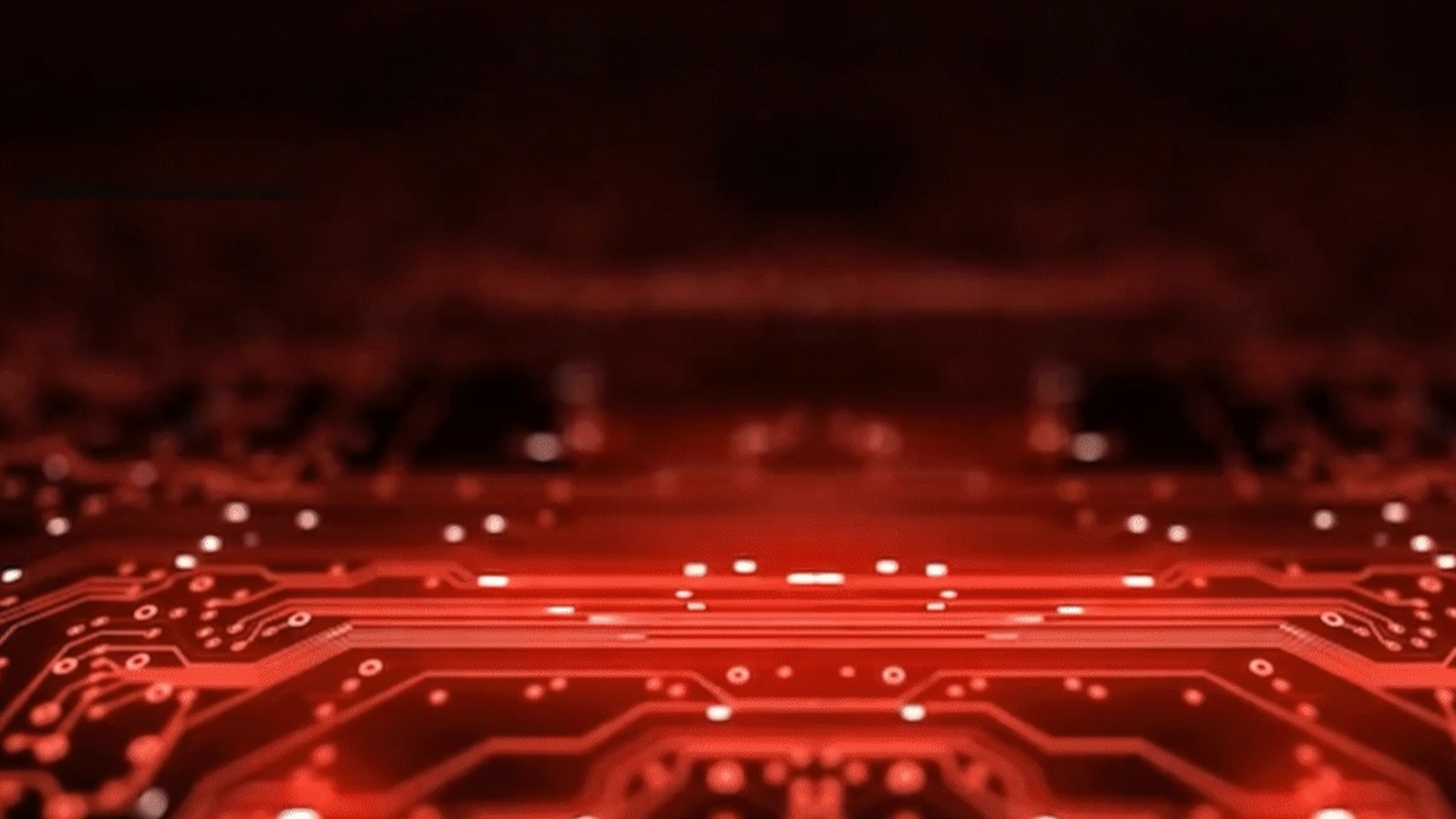


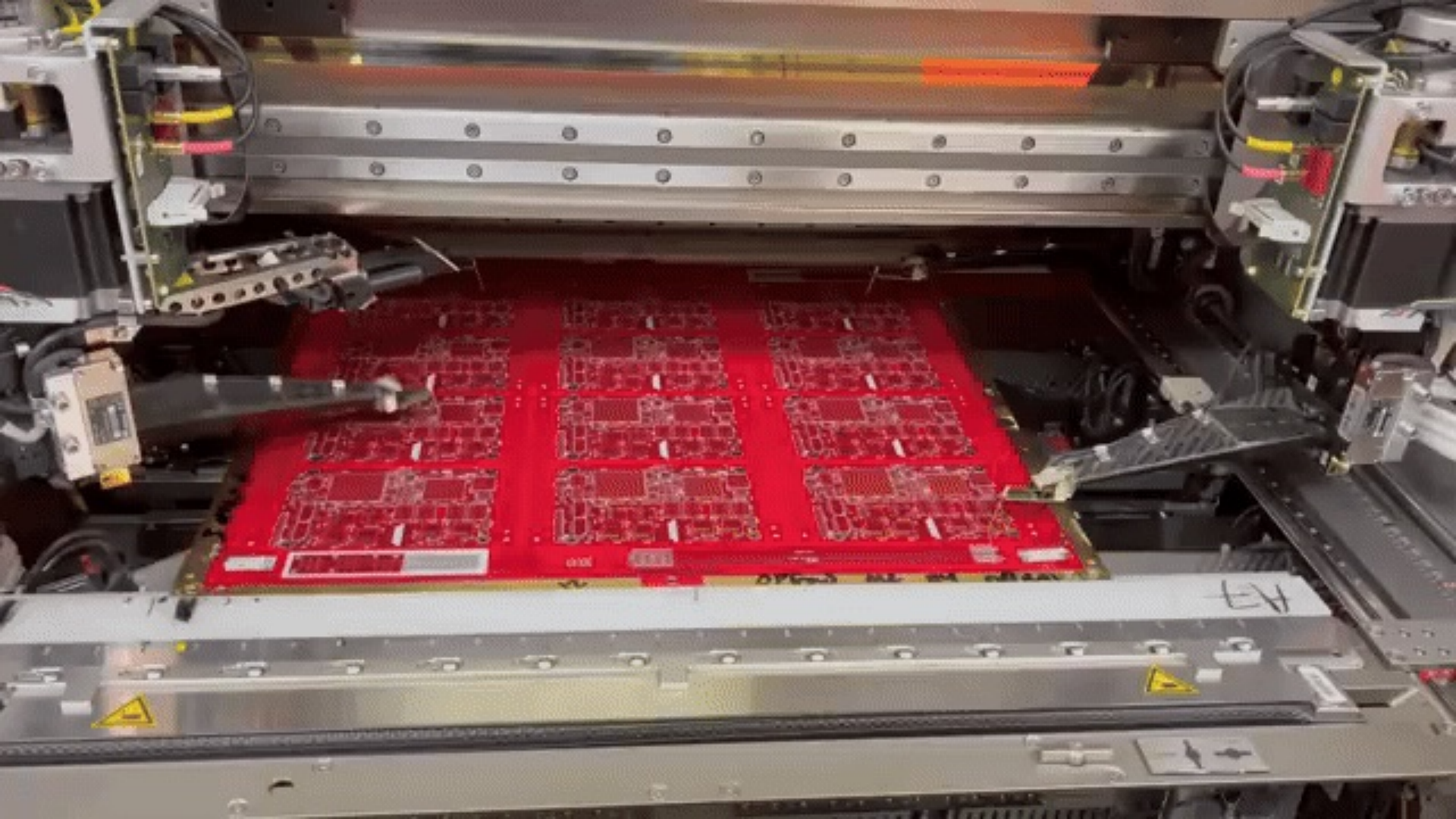
Step 1: Clamping



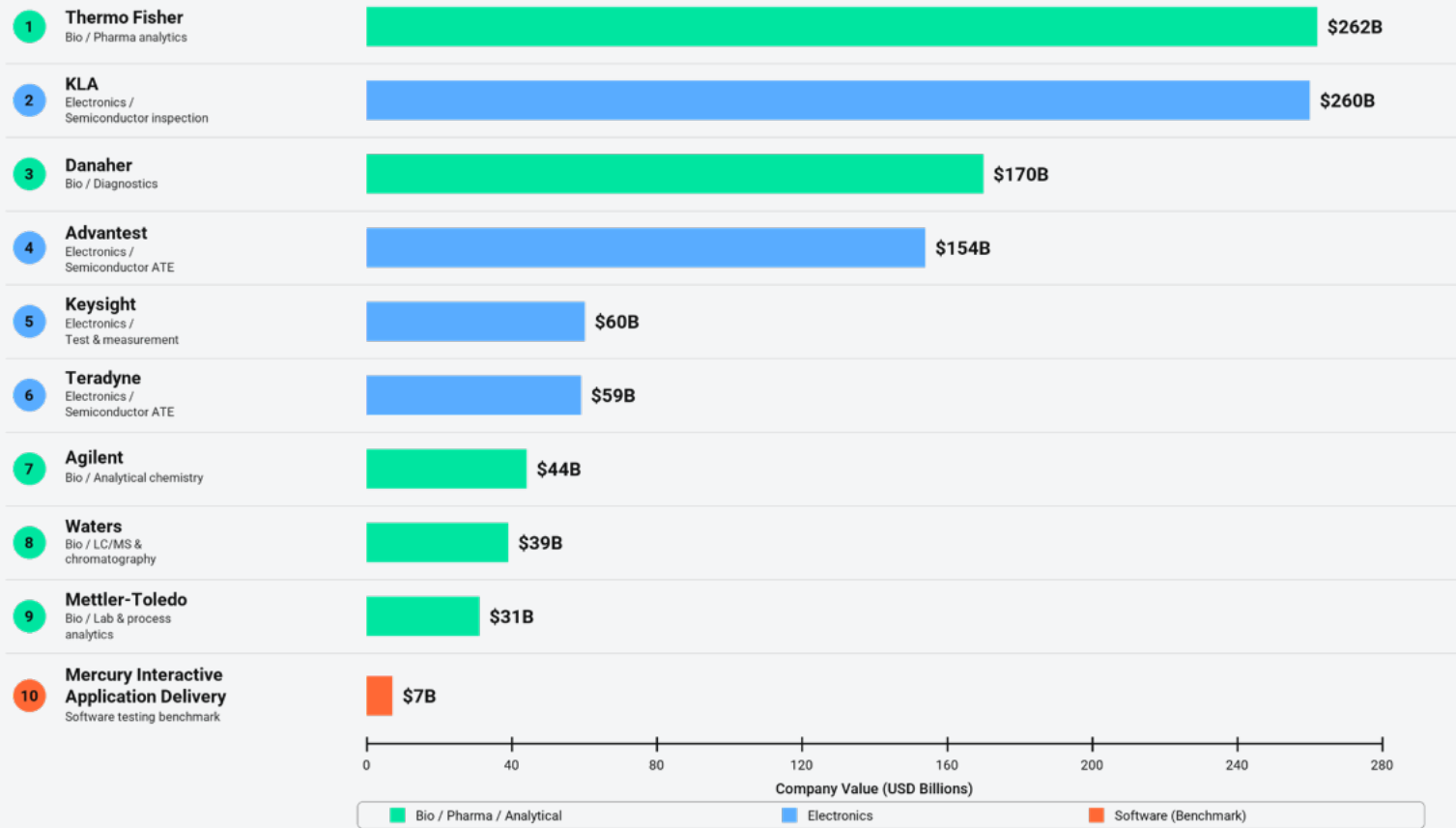




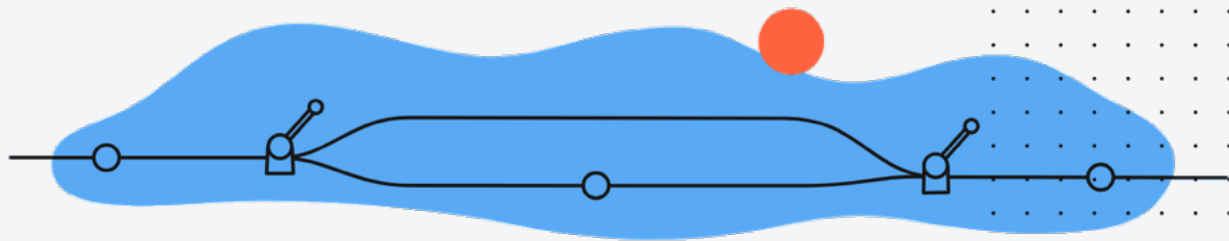




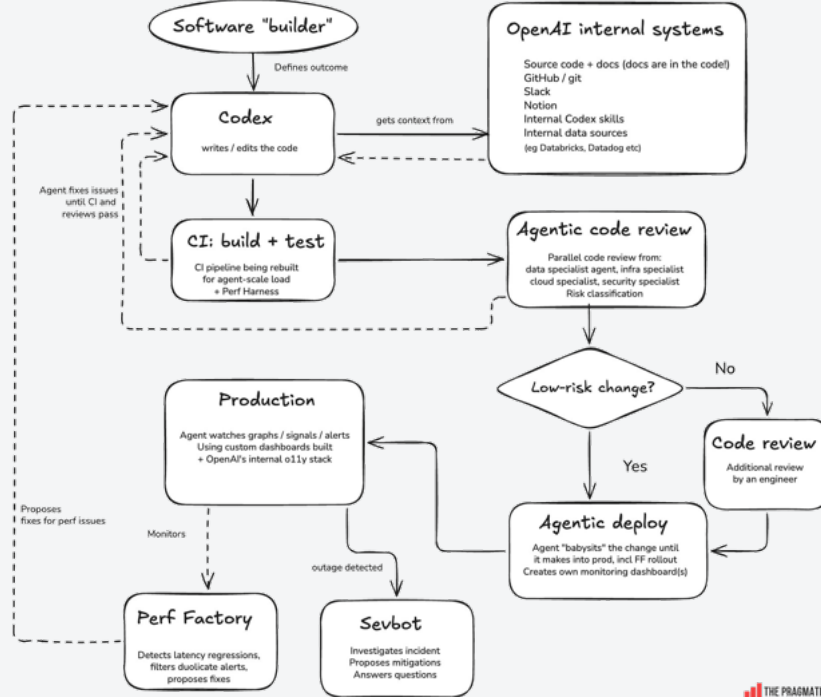




- 1.design a loop *(ideally 🌟 ➡ 💰)*
- 2.build a validator *(technically hard!)*
- 3.run & fix *(spiritually hard - don't give up!)*



The "agentic software factory" inside OpenAI



THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER
diagram by: Gergely Orosz

RAILS
WORLD

Look at all
the things
I'm not doing

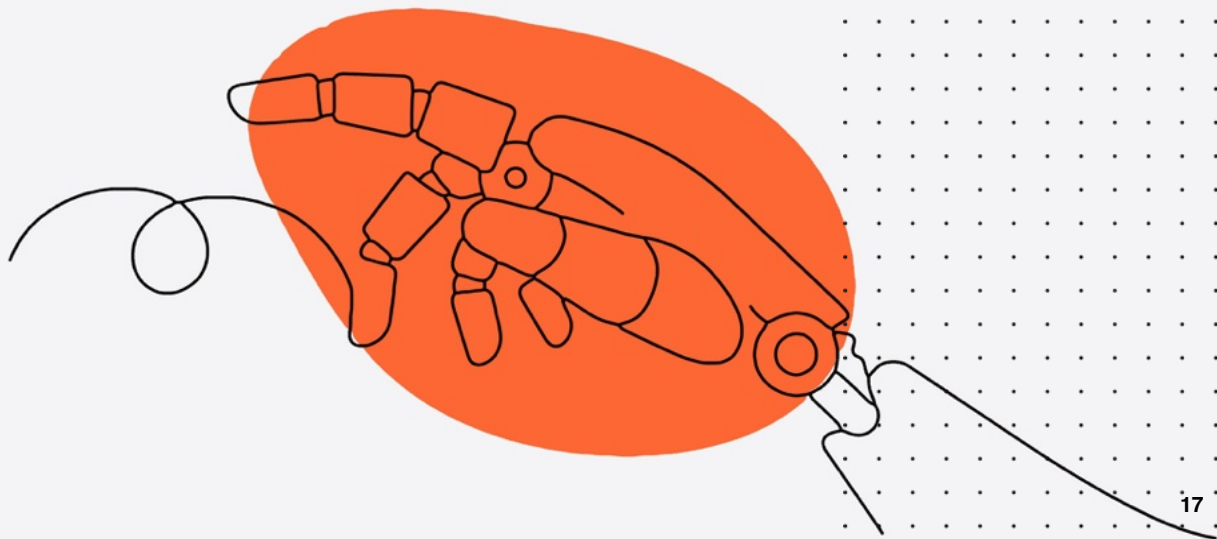
DHH

37SIGNALS



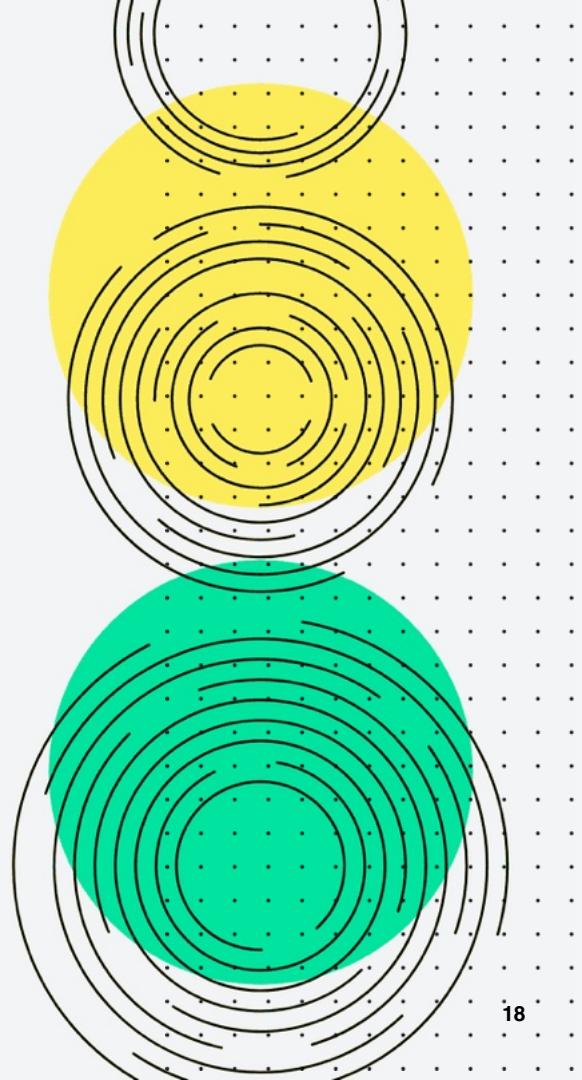
Hint

There are many things the
model cannot do

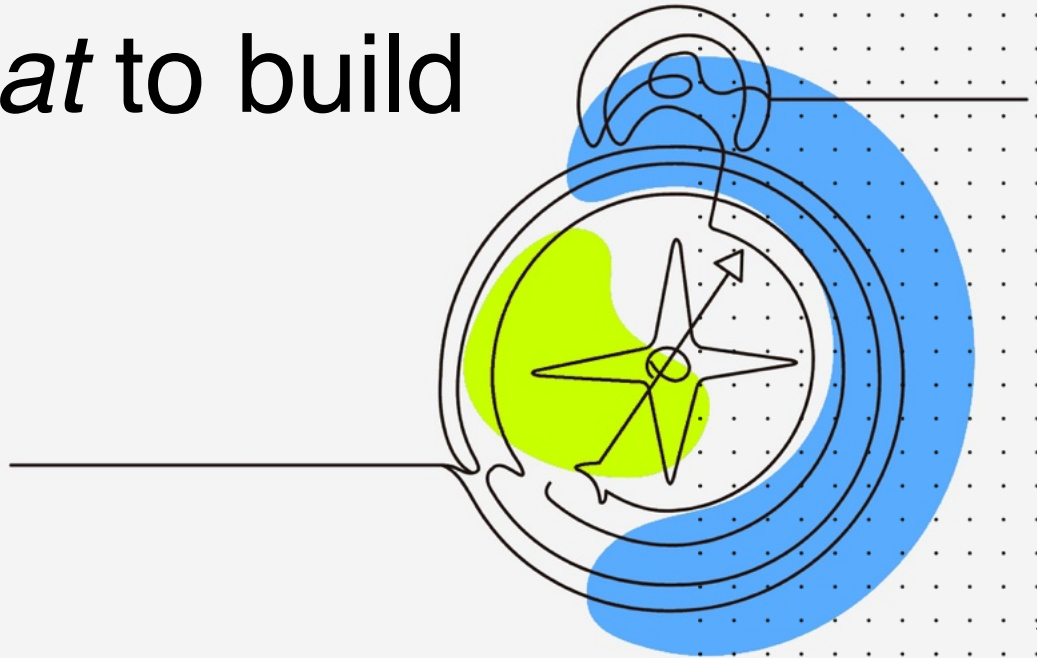


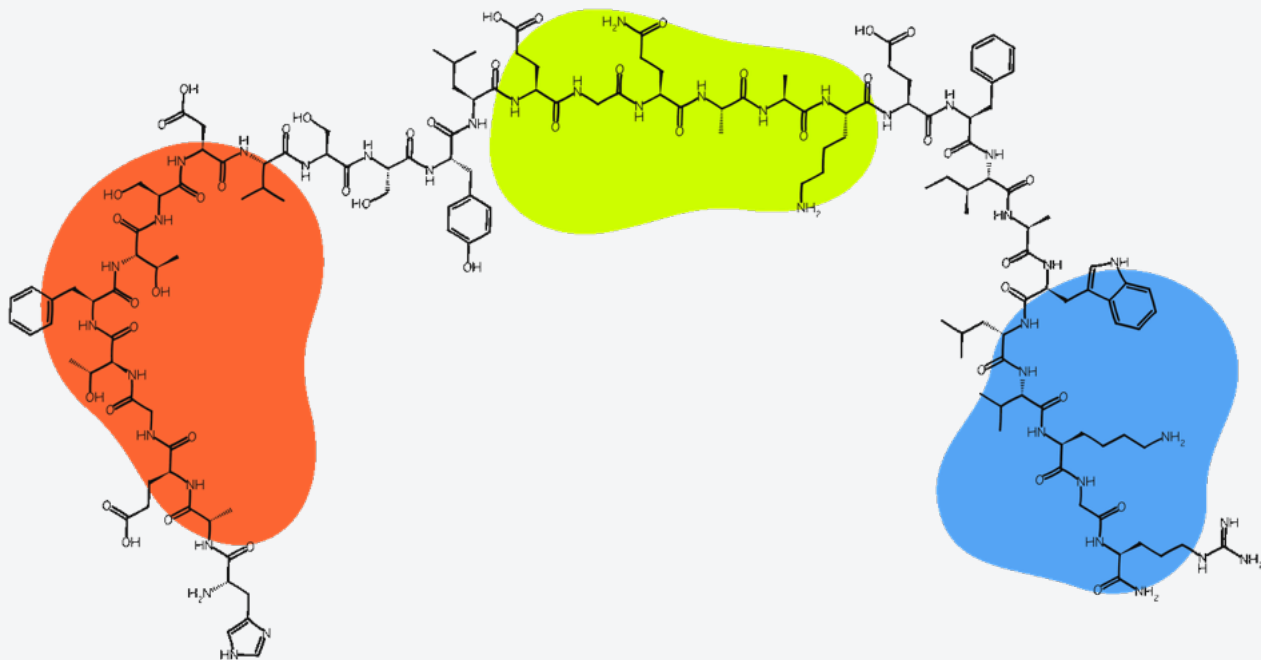
Hint

If the model *can* (just barely) do it,
your team *must stop* doing it

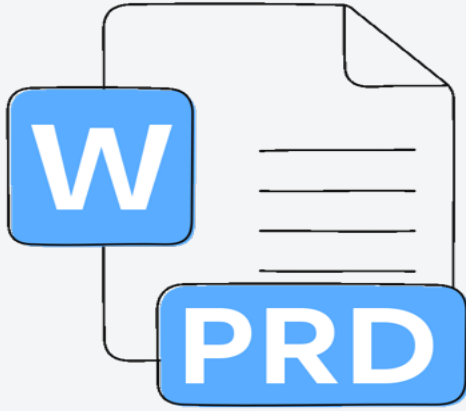


still hard: *What* to build





Design, Intent & Specification

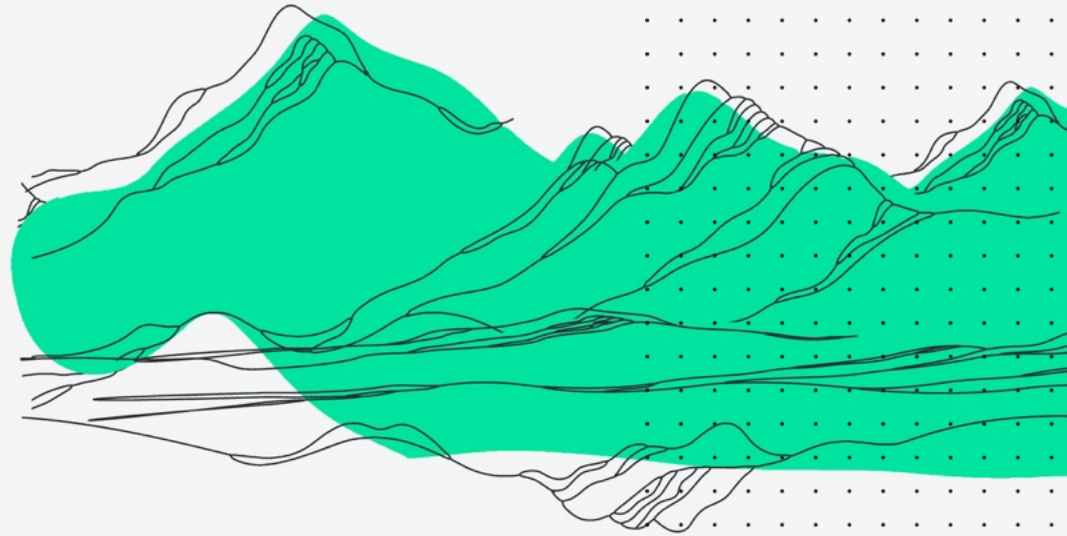


Design, Intent & Specification



Design, Intent & Specification

Day 2: Now



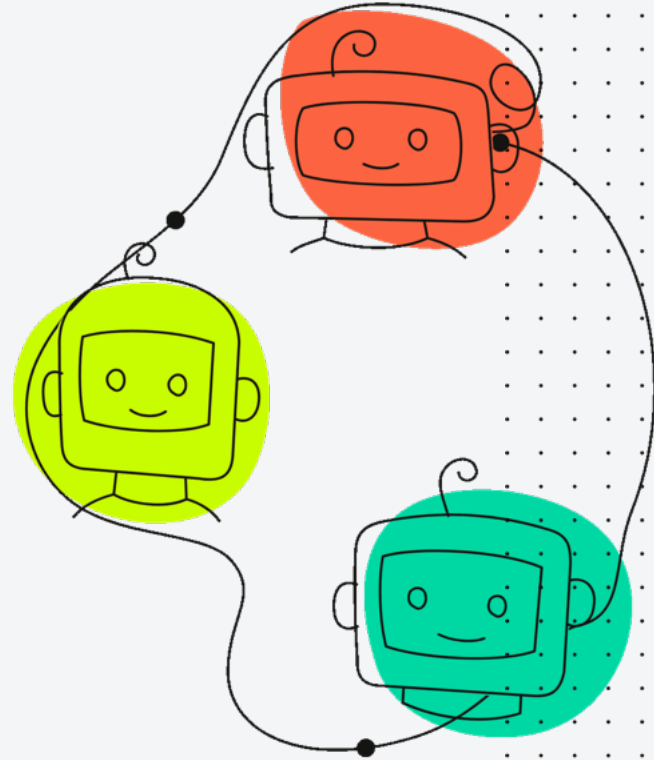
Pattern 1:
Cooks,



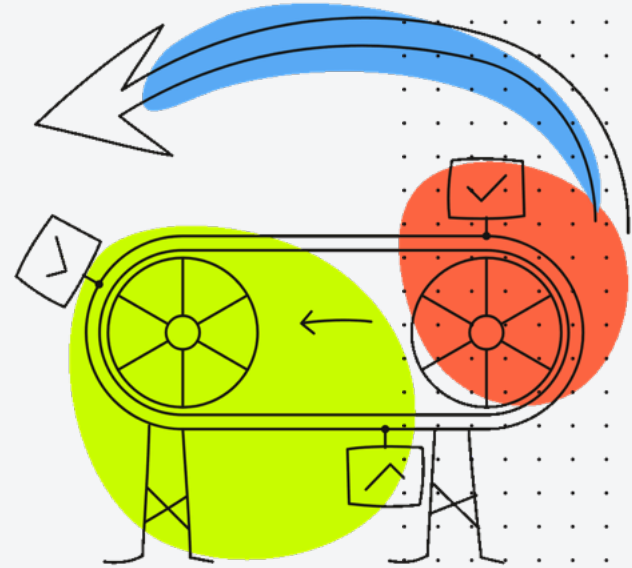
Pattern 2:
Trade Offense/ Defense



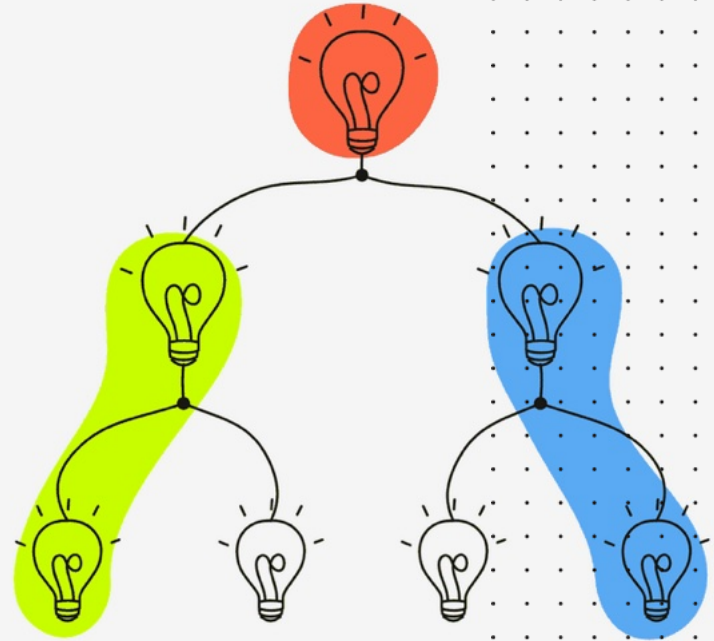
Pattern 3: Agentic Estate



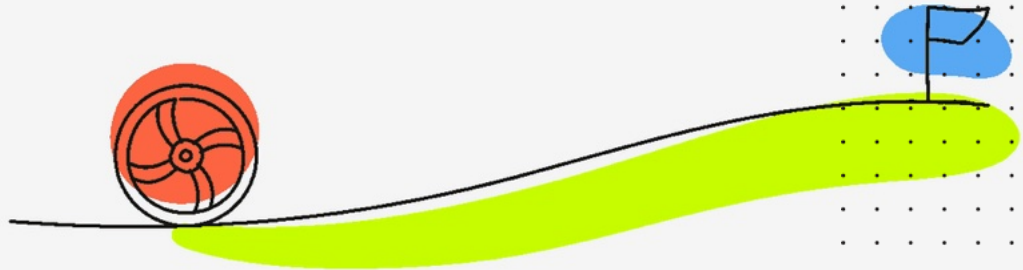
Pattern 4:
Shift ... *Way Left*



Pattern 5: Viral Competence



Pattern 6: Denial, Backsliding & Stasis



Pattern 7:
Don't Wait!

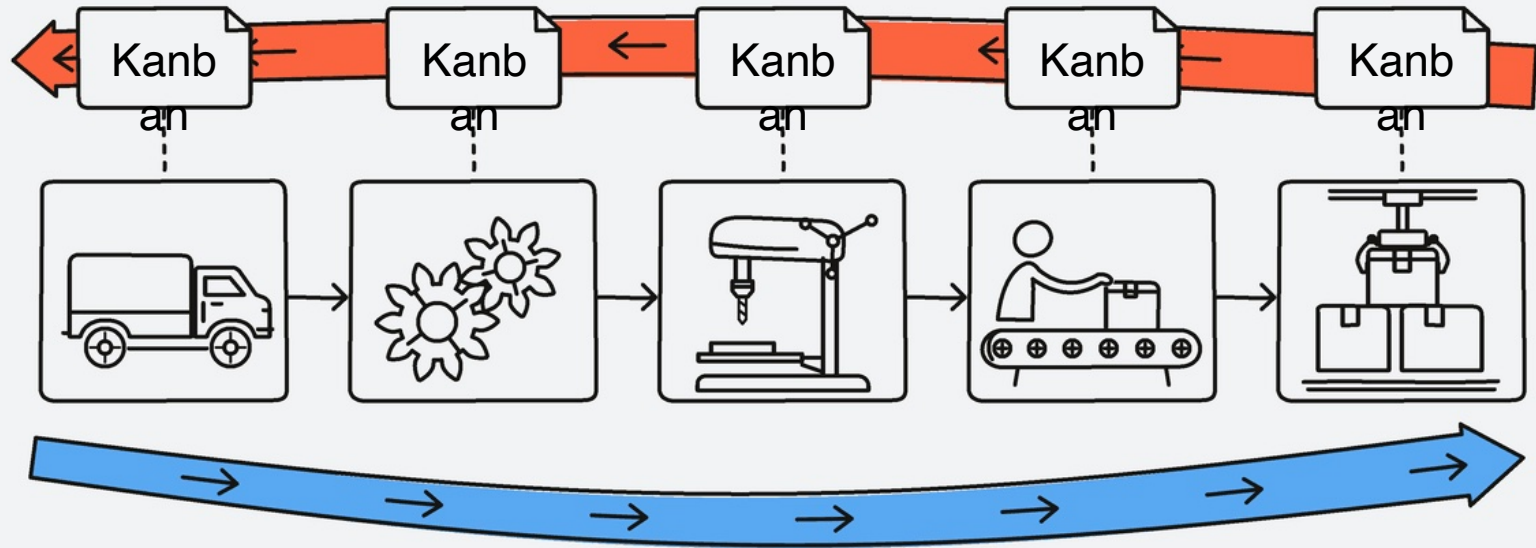




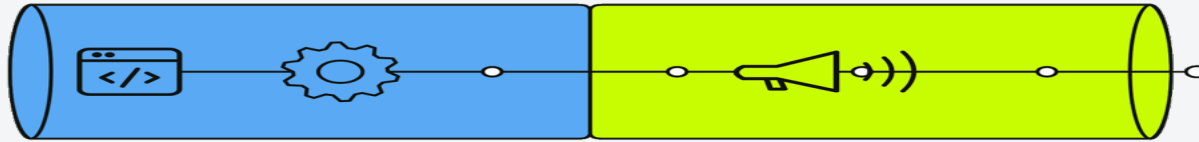
Forecast



Software Factory to Production Glut



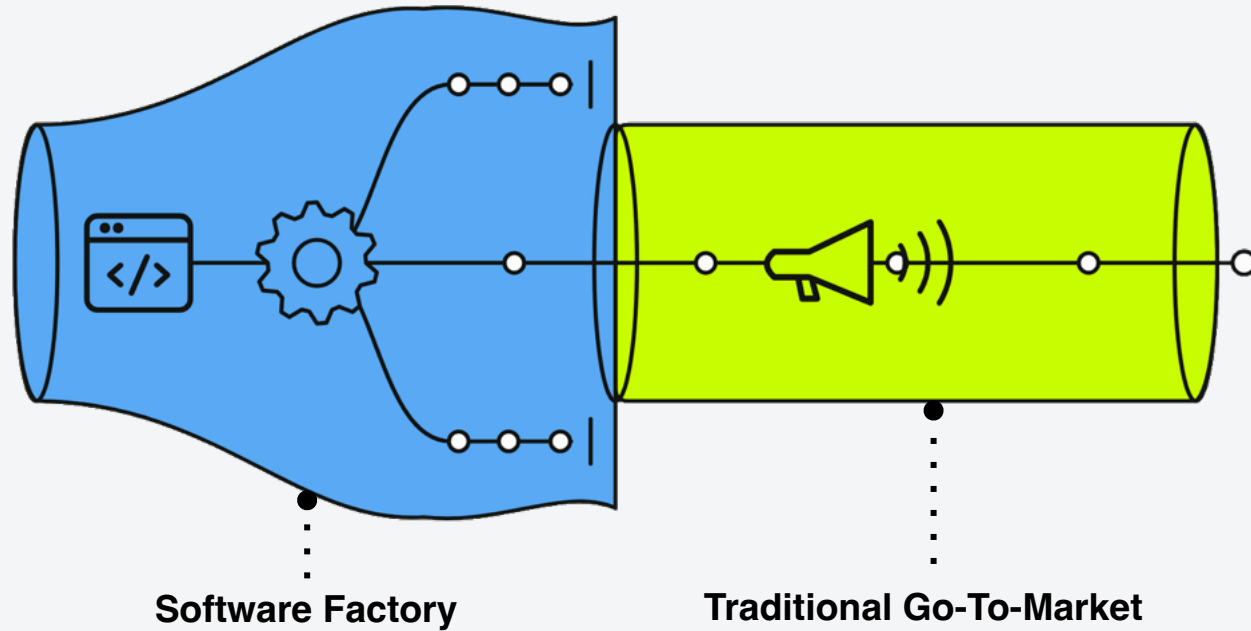
Build Your Demand Factory



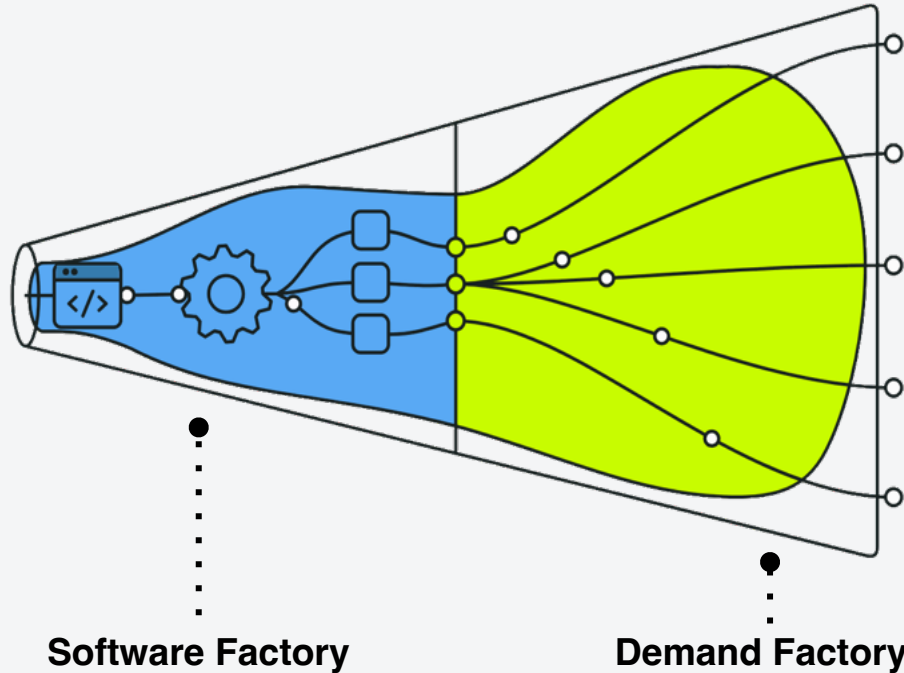
Software Factory

Traditional Go-To-Market

Build Your Demand Factory

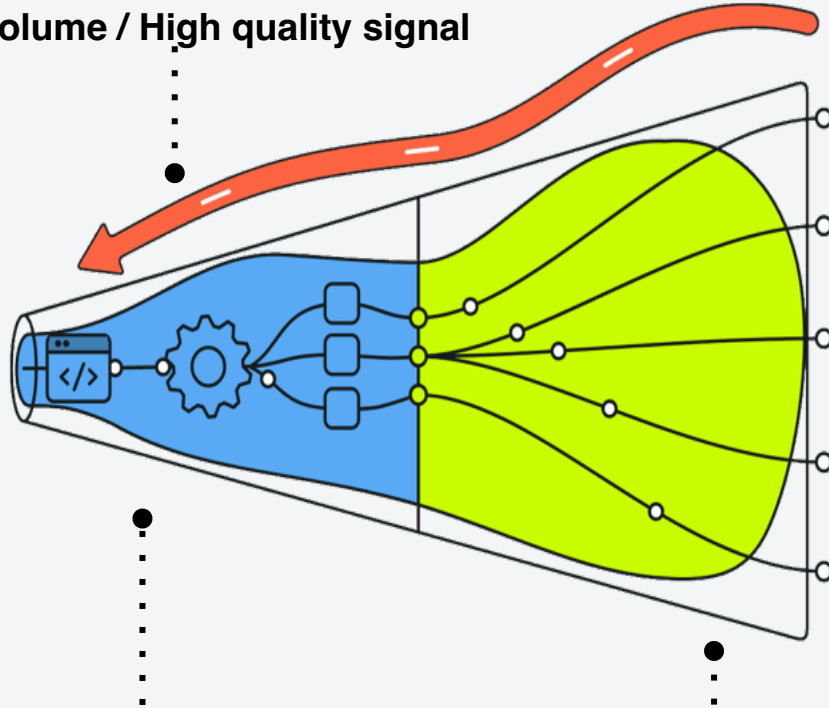


Build Your Demand Factory



Build Your Demand Factory

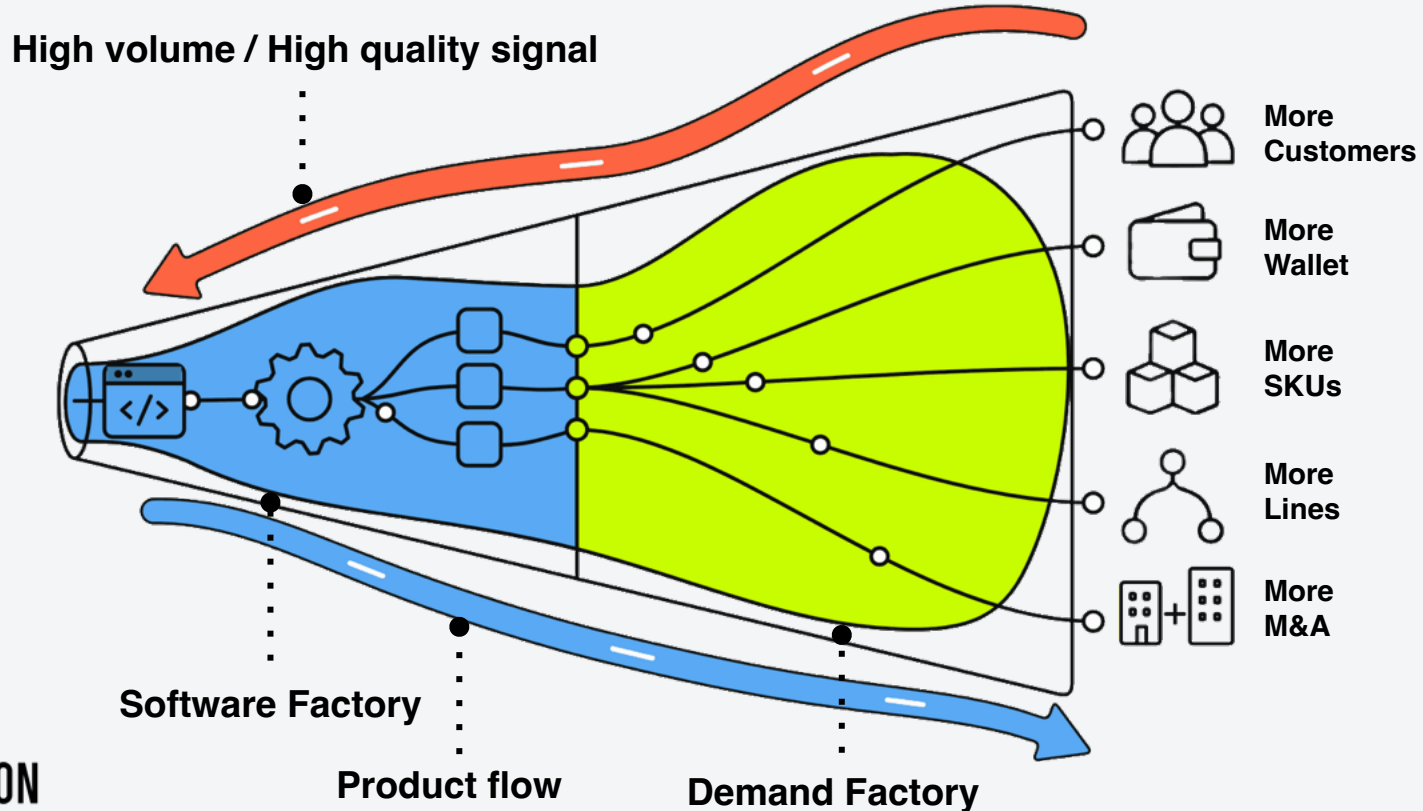
High volume / High quality signal



Software Factory

Demand Factory

Build Your Demand Factory



Justin

Diffusion AI

McCarthy

Get in Touch

justin@diffusionai.io

n.io



Help

Wanted:

Struggling Transformations

Aspiring Factory Architects

Come Visit!

Expansion Scout - Europe

Expansion Scout - India

Justin

Diffusion AI

McCarthy



Appendix

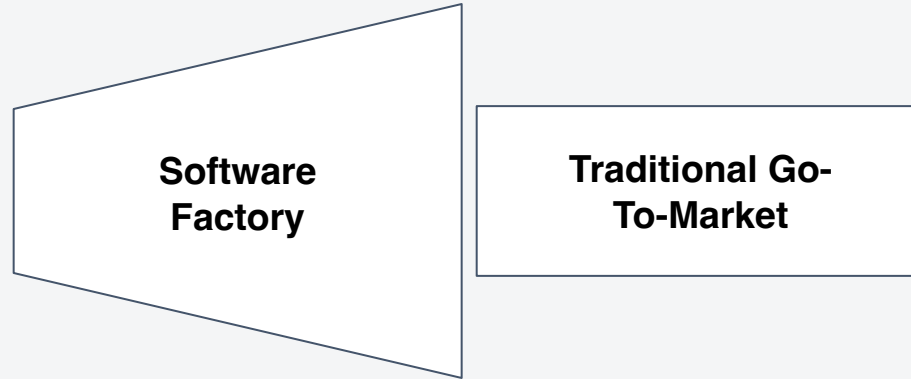


Build Your Demand Factory

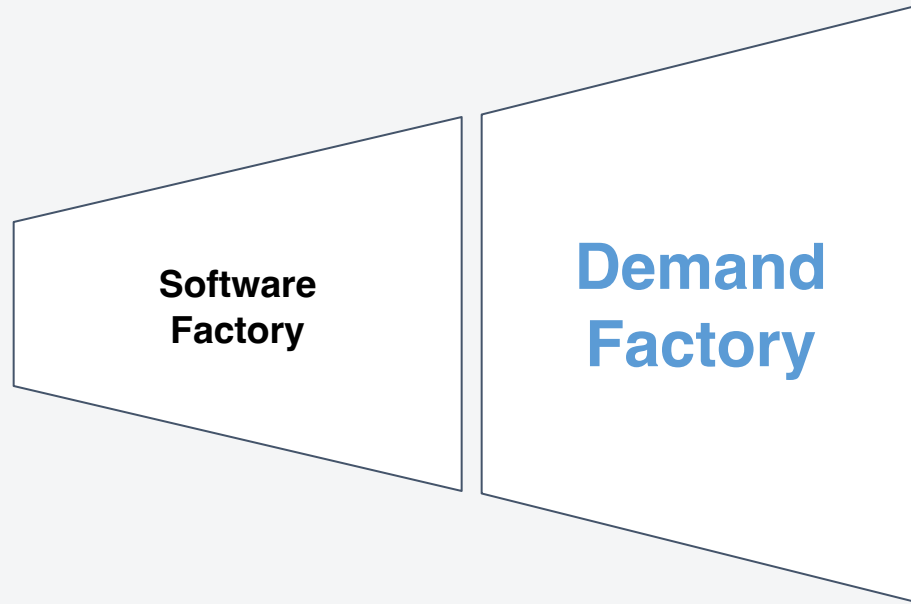
**Software
Factory**

**Traditional Go-
To-Market**

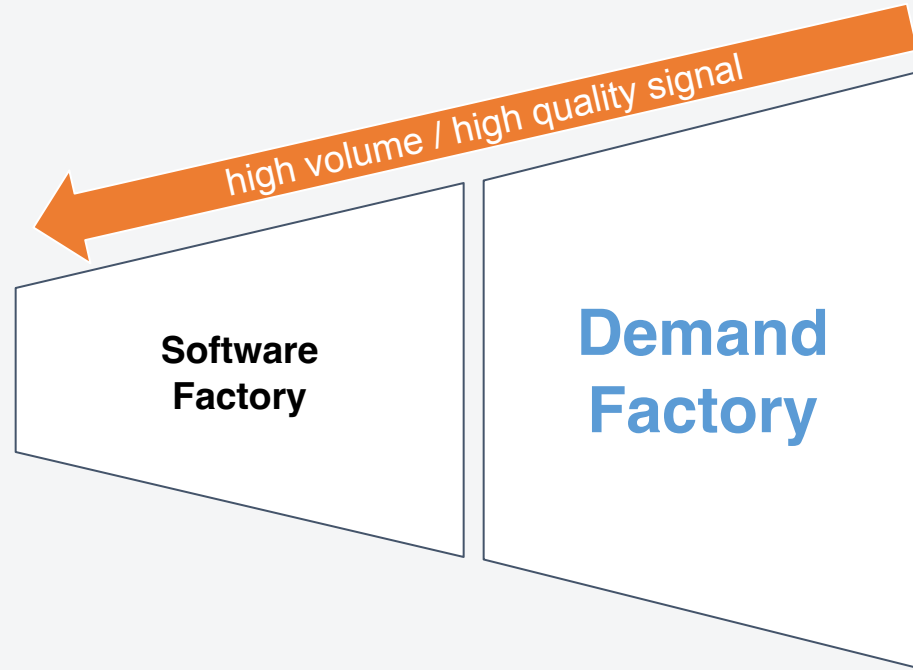
Build Your Demand Factory



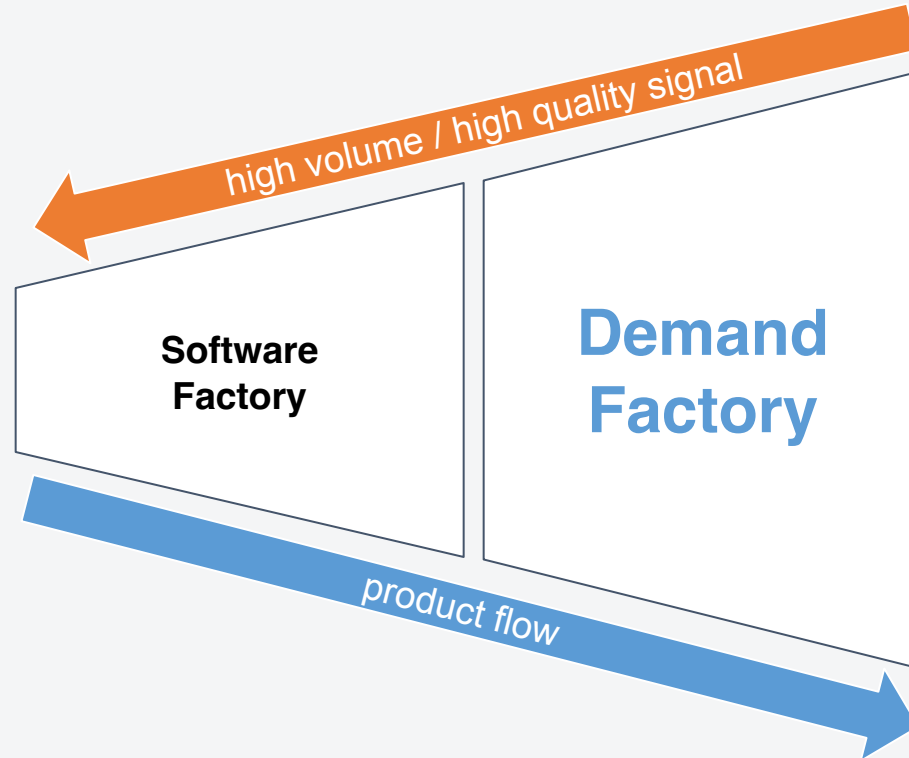
Build Your Demand Factory



Build Your Demand Factory



Build Your Demand Factory



More
Customers
More Wallet
More SKUs
More Lines
More M&A



Appendix

Justin

Diffusion AI

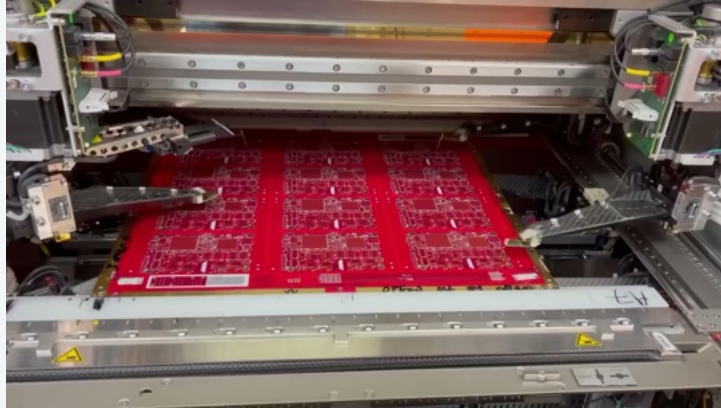
McCarthy

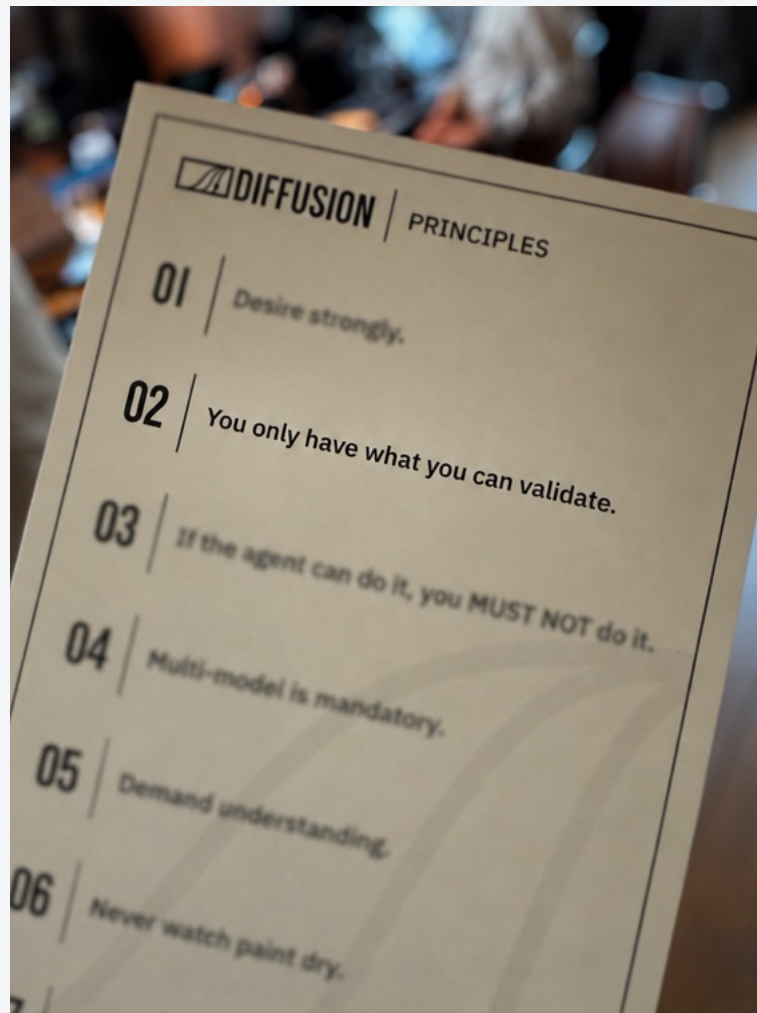


VIDEO GOES HERE FULL SLIDE

MUTE AUDIO

downloaded copy of <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A3oJ12aXAco>

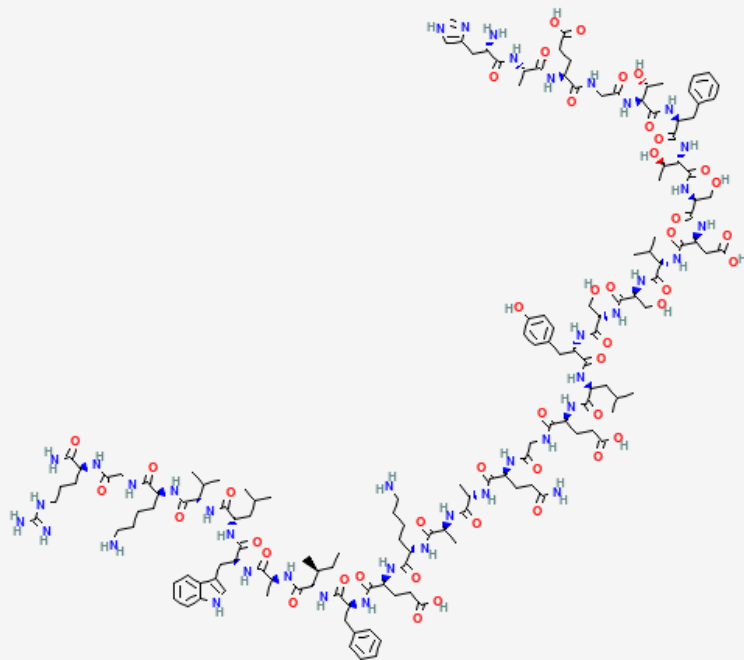




Design, Intent & Specification



Design, Intent & Specification



Software Factory to Production Glut

